

Open business and regulatory questions

MFI Manager — decisions still required, and what each one holds back

13 questions, carrying 14 entries in the decision register. Each one holds back a figure, a posting or an operation on a system that moves real money, and none can be answered from the supplied documentation. Until an answer arrives the system refuses rather than guesses — every “current behaviour” below is the conservative option, chosen so that no borrower’s balance moves for a reason nobody decided.

Answering a question does not by itself change anything. Each answer becomes a change that is reviewed and tested like any other.

Questions for the institution

Policy decisions belonging to the microfinance service provider. None can be inferred from the supplied documentation, and each governs money owed by or to a borrower, or who may hold an account.

Cross-institution staff identity

IDENTITY-01

QUESTION

May one person hold accounts at two institutions on this platform, using the same email address?

WHY IT MATTERS

Email addresses are the sign-in identifier and are globally unique, so today the second institution cannot invite someone the first has already onboarded. Relaxing it means one credential reaching two institutions’ data, which is a tenancy decision, not a convenience.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Nothing that exists. It sets whether an invitation can ever be issued twice.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Refused. Email addresses are globally unique, and the second invitation is declined with a message saying so rather than silently creating a duplicate identity.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

A yes or no. If yes, the sign-in identifier has to become the pair of email and institution, which is a schema change and not a setting.

Questions for the institution’s accountant

The business rule in each case is already decided and built. What is missing is only the journal mapping — which accounts each event posts to. None of these needs the Bank of Tanzania: they can be answered in-house, and until they are, the bookkeeping for four working features is manual.

Application fee — collection, retention and refund

FEE-04 · \$13.8

QUESTION

Which accounts does the TZS 5,000 application fee post to when it is collected, when it is retained on approval, and when it is refunded after a rejection?

WHY IT MATTERS

MSP2-02 identifies Fees under non-interest income as fees charged in day-to-day operations, which is where a retained fee plainly belongs. But the fee is refundable until the application is decided, so between collection and decision it is not income — it is money held.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

The journal posting only. Nothing else waits on this.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Every collection and refund is recorded and traceable, with the collection record kept intact when a refund is made. No journal entry is written and none is claimed on screen.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

A chart-of-accounts mapping for three events: money taken, money retained as income, money handed back.

Write-off — provided-for versus not

QUESTION

Which accounts does a write-off post to, and does the treatment differ for the part already provided for?

WHY IT MATTERS

BOT distinguishes bad debts written off (MSP2-02, Sno 14) from the provision line. A write-off posted as though nothing had been provided would double-count the loss.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

The journal posting only. Write-off itself works and is in use.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

The write-off record keeps principal and penalty separately and captures both at the instant of the decision, so either treatment can be posted afterwards against write-offs that have already happened.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

A journal mapping, and a statement of whether the provided-for portion is treated differently from the rest.

Recovery income on a written-off loan

RECOVERY-02 · §13.8

QUESTION

Which accounts does money recovered after a write-off post to?

WHY IT MATTERS

MSP2-02 carries a recoveries line (Sno 21). A recovery is not repayment income — the debt it relates to has already been written off — so posting it as a repayment would overstate interest income and understate recoveries.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

The journal posting, and wiring MSP2-02 Sno 21 to consume these records.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Recoveries are recorded in their own table with amount, date, method and loan, never as payments. The loan stays written off and no balance is restored.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

A journal mapping, and confirmation that Sno 21 is the intended line.

Capitalised interest and penalties on a restructuring

RESTRUCT-04 · §13.8

QUESTION

Which accounts does the capitalisation of unpaid interest and penalties into a new principal post to?

WHY IT MATTERS

Capitalising recognises as an asset what was previously an accrual. No supplied document establishes the entries for that.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

The journal posting. Restructuring is also withheld for a separate reason — see RESTRUCT-06.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

The restructuring record keeps principal carried, interest capitalised and penalties capitalised as three separate figures, because a total cannot be decomposed after the fact.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

A journal mapping for capitalisation.

Questions for the Bank of Tanzania

Each of these decides a figure on a filed return. Where the answer is unknown the system either refuses to guess or requires the caller to state the assumption explicitly, so that no return is compiled on an invented rule.

How a group loan is reported

QUESTION

On MSP2-03, MSP2-09 and MSP2-10, what sector, gender, age band and district does a loan report when the borrower is a group rather than a person?

WHY IT MATTERS

Every exposure query reaches those four attributes through the individual borrower on the loan. A group has no single sector, gender, age or district, so a group loan would be silently dropped from all three forms — understating the loan book on a filed return.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Lending to a group. The liability model itself is decided: the group is the borrower, liability is joint, one disbursement, one schedule, one balance.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Groups and membership are built and in use as an administrative record. The loans table is untouched — there is no group borrower and no endpoint that lends to one — so no group loan can exist to be misreported.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

Either the four attributes for a group borrower, or a rule for deriving them from the membership, or confirmation that group loans report on a different basis.

Is a restructured facility a disbursement?

RESTRUCT-06 · §13.8

QUESTION

Does MSP2-09 count a restructured facility as a disbursement in the quarter it takes effect, when no cash moves?

WHY IT MATTERS

MSP2-09 counts every loan whose disbursement date falls in the quarter. A restructuring creates a successor loan carrying a disbursement date, but no money leaves the institution — so counting it would overstate lending.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Putting restructuring in front of staff. The operation itself is built and tested.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Restructuring is withheld rather than exposed. The endpoints are not mounted unless a deployment sets `RESTRUCTURING_ENABLED`, which defaults to off, so they answer as an unknown path — absent, not merely forbidden. There is no screen for it. The restructuring link is recorded, so any facility already restructured stays identifiable and can be excluded retrospectively once this is answered.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

A yes or no. This is the single question standing between a finished, tested feature and production use.

MSP2-04 rate cells where there is no lending

BOT-FORMAT-01A

QUESTION

Should an MSP2-04 interest-rate cell be reported as 0 or left blank when the institution did no lending of that type in the quarter?

WHY IT MATTERS

They are not the same statement. Writing 0 asserts that lending took place at a rate of zero per cent; blank says there was none to report.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Nothing else. It is a presentation rule for one form.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Left blank, because a blank cell cannot be misread as a claim about a rate, and 0 can.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

A ruling on which the Bank expects.

Rate annualisation

QUESTION

Is an annualised rate the simple monthly rate times twelve, or the effective rate compounded?

WHY IT MATTERS

On a 3% monthly rate the two differ by more than six percentage points — 36% simple against 42.58% effective. That difference is reported to the Bank.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Nothing. The convention is an explicit parameter rather than a hidden choice.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Simple annualisation by default, and the convention used is echoed on the form alongside the figure, so a reader can see which was applied.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

A ruling naming the convention.

Age-band reference date

BOT-11.4

QUESTION

Is a borrower's age band taken at the reporting date, at disbursement, or at some other date?

WHY IT MATTERS

A borrower who turns 36 during a quarter falls in a different band depending on which date is used, and MSP2-10 reports by band.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Nothing. The date is a required argument, never defaulted.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

The caller must state the reference date. Nothing assumes one, so a return cannot be compiled on an unstated assumption.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

The date the Bank intends.

Housing loans under 91 days overdue

BOT-11.5

QUESTION

How is a housing loan classified when it is between 0 and 90 days overdue?

WHY IT MATTERS

BOT's housing provisioning schedule begins at 91 days and defines nothing below it. There is no Current column on the form for such a loan.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Nothing. Such loans are surfaced rather than placed.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Left unclassified and reported as a refusal, with the loans named. They are never folded into Current, because no published schedule puts them there.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

The classification and provisioning rate for that band.

Fiscal year for the year-to-date column

BOT-11.8 · BOT-11.8B

QUESTION

Does the year-to-date column run from the calendar year or the institution's fiscal year? And must a fiscal year begin on a quarter boundary?

WHY IT MATTERS

A fiscal year starting in a month that is not a quarter boundary produces a year-to-date window that does not align with the quarters being reported.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Nothing. The window is a required parameter and is echoed on the return.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

The caller states the start of the window, and the value used is reported back as part of the return. Any month is accepted; a non-aligned year produces a window that is stated rather than silently adjusted.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

Which year governs, and whether a non-quarter start is permitted.

Audit retention period

QUESTION

How long must audit records be retained, and is there a maximum beyond which they must be destroyed?

WHY IT MATTERS

Retention is a supervisory requirement. Deleting too early destroys evidence; keeping data that must be destroyed is its own breach.

WHAT IT BLOCKS

Nothing. Retention is simply not implemented.

CURRENT BEHAVIOUR

Nothing is ever deleted. The audit table has no update or delete policy for any role, so entries cannot be amended or removed even by the application.

REQUIRED TO UNBLOCK

The retention period. Note that keeping everything is the safe default and is the current behaviour.

Prepared from docs/04-DECISION-REGISTER.md, which remains the authoritative list and carries every identifier used here. Nothing in this document is a proposed answer. Where the system must do something while a question is open it refuses, or records the fact and leaves it visible — because on a system that moves real money, a guess does not announce itself.